

Common Errors:

1. Prompt Writing

Time-Dependent Language

Avoid using relative time markers like *"today"*, *"recent"*, *"upcoming"*, *"this week"*, or *"most urgent"* in prompts. The correct answer will change depending on when the task is reviewed.

✗ Incorrect (Relative)	✓ Correct (Specific)
"Check my emails from today and summarize the most urgent one."	"Find the email sent on April 9, 2026, regarding the Project X kickoff."
"Show me the nearest upcoming lease dates."	"Pull all lease events and organize them chronologically."

2. Hints (Human-level Plan) Writing

Executing Skill Commands Without Reading **SKILL.md**

The agent must discover available commands by reading the skill documentation *before* running them. Do not jump straight to execution.

✗ Incorrect	✓ Correct
"Step 1: Exec <code>zendesk_data.py list-tickets</code> "	"Step 1: Read <code>zendesk SKILL.md</code> . Step 2: Exec <code>zendesk_data.py list-tickets</code> ."

Incorrect Use of the **read** Command

The **read** command is **only** used for reading local files (like **SKILL.md**). The agent automatically gets tool call output results from **exec** or any other tool call, so you do not need to tell it to "read" the output.

✗ Incorrect	✓ Correct
"Step 6: exec python script to query database. Step 7: read the tool call output from the exec command."	"Step 6: exec python script to query the database. Step 7: Present the query result to the user."

Vague Hints

Hints should reference real, specific tools that OpenClaw can use (e.g., **write**, **read**, **exec**, **web_search**). Do not use generic verbs if a specific tool command is required.

✗ Incorrect	✓ Correct
"Create a new Python script to calculate average shoe price." (Note: there is no "create" command)	" write a new Python script to calculate average shoe price."

3. Desired Outcome: Common Errors

Vague Desired Outcome

If the database has exact numbers, include them in your desired outcome. Don't leave the expected outcome open to interpretation.

✗ Incorrect	✓ Correct
The output must include all booking sources.	The output must list all 5 booking sources with reservation counts, totaling 68 reservations: Hotels.com: 20; Direct: 18; Booking.com: 15; Expedia: 14; Direct Website: 1.